

Politician", December 3). He has not only disgraced himself but the entire political system of the country.  
A. SRIKANTIAH, *Bangalore*

The man on the street should be guided by the moral-of-the-story of Karnataka's fable—with such species of politicians roaming in the corridors of power, denial of justice is fully guaranteed.  
K.S.C. NAIR, *on e-mail*

It is high time Gowda retired from active politics and saved Karnataka further shame so that the state's political environment is able to retain at least some semblance of decency.  
V.S. GANESHAN, *Bangalore*

B.S. Yeddyurappa's defeat is bound to show BJP top brass in poor light. By falling for Gowda's machinations and not sticking to their earlier stand of supporting the dissolution of the state Assembly, the party proved that it is as opportunistic as JD(S).  
J. AKSHAY, *Secunderabad*

Gowda has been crushed, shredded, grinded and exposed threadbare in the article. The story has once again proved that the pen is mightier than the sword.  
T.V. SREE KUMAR, *Pondicherry*

Karnataka-type fiascos can be avoided if the Constitution validates the signing of MOUs between coalition partners to avoid instability.  
SHREE KRISHNA N.P., *Nashik*

## African Safari

The initiative taken by the Government to explore oil resources in Africa is

commendable ("The African Oil Rush", December 3). However, we must not appear to be an imperialist power out to bleed a poor continent.  
D.B.N. MURTHY, *Bangalore*

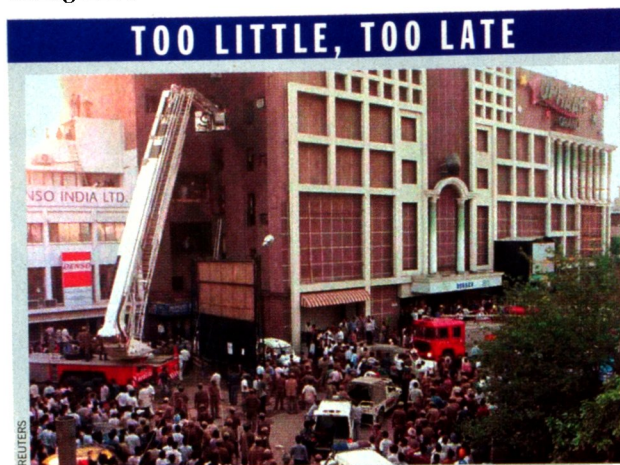
## Watch What You Eat

It is ironical that while many die of hunger, a few die of eating, and a person who eats till he is sick has to starve himself till he is well ("Mindless Eating", December 3). Excessive eating has drowned more

men than the sea. Unfortunately in our country, dietetics, as a subject, has never got the attention it deserves.  
K. PRADEEP, *Chennai*

## Correction

We wrongly carried Pratapsingh Rane as one of the chief ministers in the column titled "Hall of Shame" ("Family Lies", December 3). He was chief minister for a period of two years. The error is regretted.



In a country where the rich and the mighty are always treated with indulgence, the verdict in the infamous Uphaar fire tragedy was on expected lines ("Landmark Verdict", December 3). If this is what we call justice in this world, then the victims in this case should expect only God to deliver the goods for them.

SUBHASH C. AGRAWAL, *Delhi*

That it took the judiciary 10 years to deliver its verdict in a case as infamous as the Uphaar tragedy, speaks volumes about the fate of those cases that have not been in the public eye.

CATHY IRENE TONGPER, *Kolkata*

In cases like these, the government should constitute special courts to speed up justice. This would go a long way in preventing other Uphaaers.

MAN MOHAN BHATIA, *Delhi*

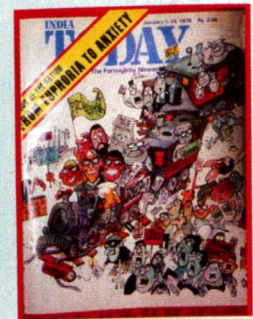
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Years Ago in India Today

JANUARY 1-15, 1978



## The Good, Bad and the Ugly

The selection of the following award winners is based on the well known "Indira Democratic Principle".

The Alchemy Award: To Prime Minister Morarji Desai for his belief that if you take India, mix it with prohibition and celibacy and stir in urine, you will get a Golden Age.



Ripley's Believe It or Not Award: To Mrs Indira Gandhi for her assertion, "There was more democracy when I was Prime Minister... never... never..."

The Advertisement Society's Idea of the Year Award: To the Inebriated Journalist who insisted that the Men's Room be renamed Morarji Room.

The "Pull It's Her" (alias Pulitzer) Happy Family Award: To Maneka Gandhi for her spirited defence of all animals, her mother-in-law and her husband.

—Chand Joshi